(4) Remove the lower suspension arm nut and bolt from the axle (Fig. 7).

(5) Remove the nut and bolt/cam bolt from the frame rail bracket and remove the lower suspension arm (Fig. 7).

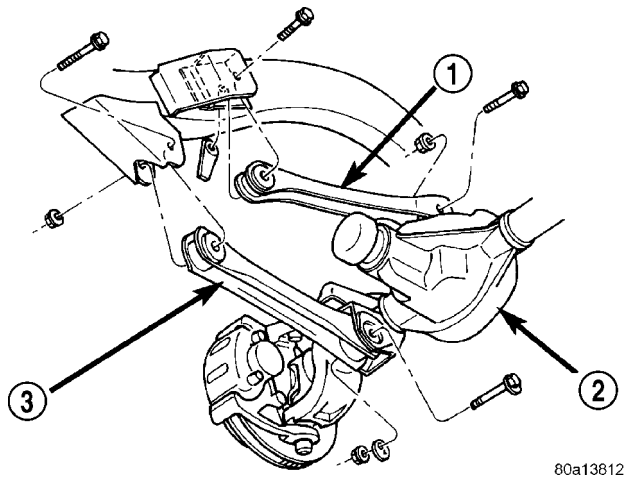

Fig. 7 Upper & Lower Suspension Arms

1 - UPPER SUSPENSION ARM
2 - FRONT AXLE
3 - LOWER SUSPENSION ARM

INSTALLATION

(1) Position the lower suspension arm in the axle bracket and frame rail bracket.

NOTE: Small holes in the side of the arm face inboard.

(2) Install the rear bolt and nut finger tighten.

(3) Install bolt/cam bolt and new nut finger tighten in the axle and align the reference marks.

(4) If equipped with ABS brakes install sensor wire to the inboard side of the arm with new clips.

(5) Lower the vehicle.

(6) Tighten axle bracket nut to 176 N·m (130 ft. lbs.).

(7) Tighten frame bracket nut to 176 N·m (130 ft. lbs.).

(8) Align vehicle to specifications. (Refer to 2 - SUSPENSION/WHEEL ALIGNMENT - STANDARD PROCEDURE).

SHOCK

DESCRIPTION

The top of the shock absorbers are bolted to a frame bracket. The bottom of the shocks are bolted to the axle brackets.

OPERATION

The shock absorbers dampen jounce and rebound motion of the vehicle over various road conditions and limit suspension rebound travel.

DIAGNOSIS AND TESTING - SHOCK ABSORBER

A knocking or rattling noise from a shock absorber may be caused by movement between mounting bushings and metal brackets or attaching components. These noises can usually be stopped by tightening the attaching nuts. If the noise persists, inspect for damaged and worn bushings, and attaching components. Repair as necessary if any of these conditions exist.

A squeaking noise from the shock absorber may be caused by the hydraulic valving and may be intermittent. This condition is not repairable and the shock absorber must be replaced.

The shock absorbers are not refillable or adjustable. If a malfunction occurs, the shock absorber must be replaced. To test a shock absorber, hold it in an upright position and force the piston in and out of the cylinder four or five times. The action throughout each stroke should be smooth and even.

The shock absorber bushings do not require any type of lubrication. Do not attempt to stop bushing noise by lubricating them. Grease and mineral oil-base lubricants will deteriorate the bushing.

REMOVAL

(1) Remove the nut, retainer and grommet from the upper stud through engine compartment access hole (Fig. 8).

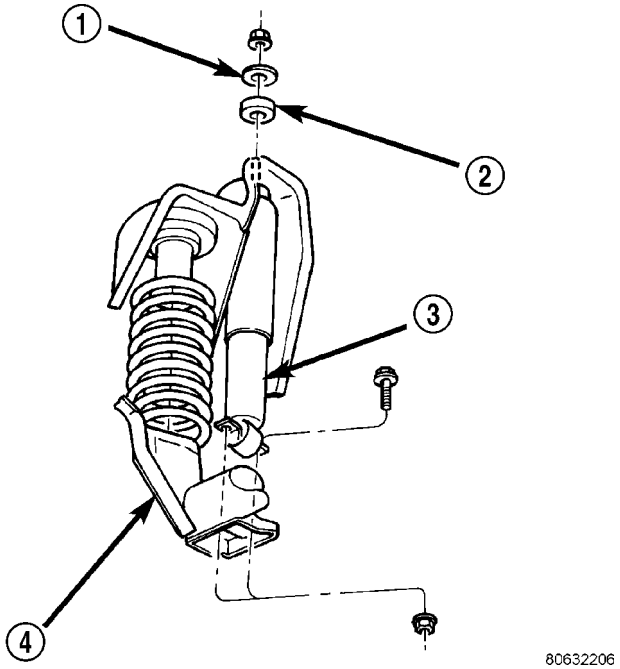

Fig. 8 Coil Spring & Shock Absorber

1 - RETAINER
2 - GROMMET
3 - SHOCK
4 - FRONT AXLE